17.24 Down Syndrome*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Mother says, "The baby is floppy and feeds slowly." **Objective** • Hypotonia • Weak suck	**ACTUAL** Ineffective infant feeding dynamics related to hypotonia as evidenced by a weak suck and slow feeding.	• Enough intake, with weight gain.	• Support the jaw and chin during feeds. • Offer small, frequent feeds. • Weigh regularly.	• Outcome reached as he gains weight.
Subjective • Mother asks, "What will his future be?" **Objective** • Parents distressed • Many questions	**ACTUAL** Inadequate health knowledge [parental] related to the child's condition and needs as evidenced by questioning.	• Parents describe the follow-up he needs.	• Explain heart, thyroid, hearing and vision screening. • Refer to early intervention services. • Put the family in touch with support groups.	• Considered met when they describe the plan.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Hypotonia • Frequent colds	**RISK** Risk for infection as evidenced by risk factors: recurrent respiratory infections.	• No serious infection.	• Make sure immunizations are complete. • Teach the early signs of a chest infection. • Teach positions that help breathing.	• Goal reached if no infection develops.

*References for this care plan: [17], [35], [38]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.